examining the nature of the NCEPG strategy and the 'non-traditional' threats that exist in the aftermath of 9/11 and Pakistan's involvement in America's 'war on terror'. It will explore the state's response to these threats, and how its policies have increasingly turned it into a security state, where ironically such policies work only so far as the citizen does not question the security apparatus. There are already pockets of resistance that are critical of the security state, but the student responses in this study show that the extent of this critique is limited. Those who do critique risk retaliation by the security services, where such retaliation may intimidate others. The students in this study in their assessment of the security apparatus have predominantly been in favour of the military and the state in its fight against terrorism, explaining the actions of the security state as a necessary response to the security situation that confronts Pakistan today.

Terrorism in Pakistan

Question: What makes you Pakistani?

Patience and the important toleration, important to tolerate everything, corruption, load shedding, terrorism.

(Student, Female, Lahore)

For many young Pakistanis in this study, the reality of the 'war on terror', the normalization of a security discourse in their everyday lives, from checkpoints to learning to distinguish between a fire alarm and a terrorist alarm (though mostly in private universities) is the only normality they know. For many, like this female student, being Pakistani is linked to this normality. Pakistan has been transformed by terrorism. The state and the people have been marked by the excesses of violent deaths that started to increase slowly during the 1980s and then gained momentum after 2002 as the after-effects of 9/11 swept across the region. However, even the face of terror has changed over the decades.

Early on Pakistan was racked by sectarian violence due largely to Zia's policies that made Sunni Islam the 'right' Islam to follow. The impact of sectarianism was felt across the country, as observed by this Hazara participant living in Lahore: '*We have always been with Pakistan but now at this moment because of target killings, sectarianism no place is safe. Only 40% of the Hazara community is left*' (Teacher, Male, Quetta); '*Sindh also has too diverse a culture which is a problem*